METRIC

A-A-20133B
December 23, 1998
SUPERSEDING
A-A-20133A
September 30, 1993

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

SAUCE, SPAGHETTI, MEATLESS

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

1. SCOPE.

1.1 This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers meatless spaghetti sauce, including product with no salt added, packed in commercially acceptable containers, suitable for use by the Federal, State, local governments, and other interested parties.

2. CLASSIFICATION.

2.1 The meatless spaghetti sauce shall conform to one of the following types, styles, and flavors in the following list which shall be specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

Types, styles, and flavors.

Type I - Regular
Type II - Light or lite (calories)
Type III - Low sodium
Type IV - No salt added

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc., and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: Head, Food Quality Assurance Staff, Fruit and Vegetable Programs, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, STOP 0243, 1400 Independence Ave., SW, Washington, DC 20250-0243 or telephone (202) 720-9939 or FAX (202) 690-0102.

FSC 8940

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Style A - Smooth
Style B - Chunky (may include; but not limited to: pieces of tomatoes, mushrooms, onions, and/or peppers)

Flavor 1 - Traditional
Flavor 2 - Garden vegetable
Flavor 3 - Tomato and basil
Flavor 4 - Mushroom
Flavor 5 - Peppers and onions
Flavor 6 - Tomato and onions
Flavor 7 - Other

3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

3.1 **Processing:** The meatless spaghetti sauce is a ready-to-use sauce prepared from food grade components and processed using good manufacturing procedures.

3.2 **Ingredients:** The meatless spaghetti sauce may include; but not limited to: water; tomato products (tomato paste, tomato puree, and tomato concentrate); sugar, olive oil or soybean, and/or cottonseed oil, corn and canola oil; cheese; onions, mushrooms, peppers, onion powder, garlic powder, other spices, citric acid, natural flavorings, and other safe and suitable ingredients. Non-vegetable based thickeners shall be less than 2 percent of the product formulation.

3.3 **Finished product:**

3.3.1 **Flavor and odor:** The meatless spaghetti sauce shall have a well blended tomato flavor and aroma, free from any objectionable flavors, with reasonable amount of salt (except Types III and IV) and spices.

3.3.2 **Color:** The meatless spaghetti sauce shall be bright, typical red-orange tomato color.

3.3.3 **Consistency:** The Style A smooth meatless spaghetti sauce shall possess a smooth texture and mouth feel, and be practically free from particles of seed, skin, or core material. The Style B chunky meatless spaghetti sauce shall possess a chunky texture of selected diced ingredients that is practically free from particles of seed and or core material.

3.3.4 **Suspension:** The meatless spaghetti sauce shall not stratify or separate.

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3.3.5 Calories: "Light" or "Lite" calories as referenced in 21 CFR Part 101.60(b) means that if 50 percent or more of the calories are from fat, fat must be reduced by at least 50 percent of referenced amount. If less than 50 percent of calories are from fat, fat must be reduced at least 50 percent or calories reduced at least 1/3 per referenced amount.

3.3.6 Low sodium: In reference to 21 CFR Part 101.61, low sodium is 140 mg or less per referenced amount (and per 50 g if referenced amount is small).

3.3.7 Defects: The meatless spaghetti sauce shall be free from any defect that more than slightly affects the appearance or eating quality.

3.3.8 Foreign material: All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from evidence of rodent or insect infestation.

3.4 Analytical and microbiological requirements: Unless otherwise specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, the analytical and microbiological requirements for meatless spaghetti sauce shall be as follows:

Soluble Solids	10.0 to 14.0 percent
Sodium	0.5 to 2.0 percent (Type I only)
Sodium	Must not exceed the limits specified in 21 CFR 101.61 (Type III and VI)
pH	3.9 to 4.4
Consistency	Not less than 4.0 or more than 10.5 centimeters in 30 seconds at 20°C ± 1°C
Coliform	Less than 10 MPN (Most Probable Number)/gram
E. coli	Less than 3.0 MPN/gram

Analytical methods required for the above levels shall be in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC, or other methods specified.

3.4.1 Analytical procedure: One unopened container sample unit shall be submitted from each lot for testing.

3.4.2 Preparation of sample: The sample shall be prepared in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC International Method 945.68.

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3.4.3 Analytical and microbiological testing: When specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, analytical and microbiological analyses shall be made in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC International, or other methods specified as follows:

Test	Method
Solids (Soluble) in Tomato Products	932.12
Sodium	966.16
pH of Acidified Foods	981.12
Coliform	992.30
E coli	996.09
Consistency	Bostwick Consistometer

3.4.4 Test results: The test results for solids and sodium (Type I only) shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent. The test results for sodium (Type III and Type IV) shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 mg. Test results for pH shall be reported the nearest 0.1 value. The *coliform* and *E. coli* shall be reported to the nearest 1.0 per gram. Test results for consistency shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 centimeter in 30 seconds. Any result not conforming to the analytical requirements shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS.

4.1 The delivered meatless spaghetti sauce shall comply with all applicable Federal, State, and local mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sale of the meatless spaghetti sauce in the commercial marketplace. Delivered meatless spaghetti sauce shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

5. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS. *Purchaser may specify 5.1 or 5.2.*

5.1 Product conformance. The meatless spaghetti sauce provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this CID, conform to the producer's own specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and be the same meatless spaghetti sauce offered for sale in the commercial market. The purchaser reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

5.2 USDA certification. When required in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order that product quality or acceptability or both be determined, the Processed Products Branch (PPB), USDA shall be the certifying activity and shall make the determination in accordance with applicable PPB procedures. The meatless spaghetti sauce shall be examined or analyzed or both in accordance with applicable provisions in the CID, solicitation, contract, or purchase order, and

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when applicable, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers in effect on the date of the solicitation.

6. PACKAGING.

6.1 **Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and case marking.** Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and case marking shall be as specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

7. NOTES.

7.1 **Purchasers shall specify:**

- The type(s), style(s), and flavor(s) of sauce required.
- When analytical and microbiological testing is to be completed.
- Certification by PPB for meatless spaghetti sauce.

7.2 **USDA certification contact.**

For USDA certification, contact the Head, Food Quality Assurance Staff, STOP 0243, 1400 Independence Avenue, SW, Washington, DC 20250-0243 or telephone (202) 720-9939 or FAX (202) 690-0102.

7.3 **Sources of documents.**

7.3.1 **Source of information for nongovernmental document is as follows:**

Copies of the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC International may be obtained from: **AOAC International, 481 North Frederick Avenue, Suite 500, Gaithersburg, MD 20877.**

7.3.2 **Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:**

Applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act are contained in 21 CFR Parts 1 to 199. This document may be purchased from: **Superintendent of Documents, ATTN: New Orders, P. O. Box 371954, Pittsburgh, PA 15250-7954.** Credit Card (MasterCard or VISA) purchases may be made by calling the Superintendent of Documents on (202) 512-1803 **or on the Internet at: http:// www.nara.gov/fedreg.**

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Copies of the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers are available from: **Chairperson, Condition of Container Committee, U.S. Department of Agriculture, STOP 0243, 1400 Independence Avenue, SW, Washington, DC 20250-0243.**

Civil agencies and other interested parties may obtain copies of this CID from: **General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Specifications Section, Suite 8100, 470 East L'Enfant Plaza, SW, Washington, DC 20407.**

Military activities should submit requests for copies of this CID to: **Standardization Documents Order Desk, Defense Automation Printing Service, 700 Robbins Avenue, Building 4D, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.**

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Military Coordinating Activity

Army - GL

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review Activities

Army - MD, QM
Navy - MC
DLA - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
HHS - NIH, IHS
USDA - FV
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

USDA - FV

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